

Laura Chepkemai

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Detail-oriented Systems Support Engineer with experience supporting high-availability financial and telecommunications platforms, including transaction-based systems and integrations. Proven expertise in system monitoring, incident handling, root cause analysis (RCA), automation, DevOps practices and performance optimization to achieve enterprise-grade availability targets (99.999%).

CORE SKILLS

Python | React | RESTful APIs | Docker | GitHub | Azure DevOps | CI/CD Pipelines | Grafana | RabbitMQ | Server Monitoring | Log Analysis | PostgreSQL | SQL | Database Performance Optimization | ITIL Service Operations | Agile | Scrum | Incident & Problem Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Support Engineer

Onfon Media Ltd — Nairobi, Kenya
November 2025-Present

Provide operational and technical support for transaction-based financial services and messaging platforms including Bulk SMS, USSD services, and CredoFaster transaction solutions, ensuring high availability and rapid incident resolution.

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Monitor and support mission-critical financial and messaging systems to maintain high system uptime aligned to enterprise availability targets.
- Provide technical support for transaction services including monitoring transaction flows, reconciling delivery failures, and resolving integration issues.
- Support mobile money-style integrations and API-based financial systems, ensuring seamless interoperability between internal and third-party platforms.
- Perform detailed root cause analysis (RCA) for incidents affecting transaction processing, message queues, and USSD sessions.
- Monitor infrastructure and applications using Grafana and logging tools to proactively detect anomalies and prevent outages.
- Manage messaging queues (RabbitMQ), ensuring reliability, message durability, and optimized throughput.
- Troubleshoot USSD session failures, timeout errors, transaction drops, and integration breakdowns while ensuring MTTR targets are met.
- Escalate complex incidents to internal and external teams, track resolution progress, and ensure closure within SLA.
- Maintain accurate ticket documentation in service management tools including incident categorization, prioritization, and resolution logging.
- Generate system performance and availability reports for stakeholders.
- Document recurring issues and develop operational runbooks to improve service reliability.
- Support server monitoring, performance tuning, and capacity management initiatives.

DevOps Engineer

IronRim (Remote)

Nov 2024 – July 2025

Supported cloud-native and containerized enterprise applications with strong focus on reliability engineering, automation, and operational excellence.

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Provided Level 2/3 support for containerized applications running on AWS and Docker environments.
- Investigated production incidents, conducted root cause analysis, and implemented permanent fixes to prevent recurrence.
- Built and automated CI/CD pipelines using GitHub and Azure DevOps to improve deployment consistency and reduce human error.
- Implemented containerization strategies using Docker to improve portability and environment consistency.
- Improved monitoring and alerting mechanisms by refining thresholds and automating health checks.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams under ITIL change management processes for controlled releases and configuration updates.
- Reduced deployment failures through automation and version-controlled infrastructure processes.
- Authored technical documentation, SOPs, and knowledge base articles to enhance operational readiness.
- Participated actively in Agile sprint cycles and backlog refinement sessions.

Software Engineer

Kenya Girl Guides

April 2024 – November 2024

Designed and developed a scalable membership and payment-enabled platform with secure data handling and transactional integrity.

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Designed and implemented RESTful APIs for payment processing and transaction workflows.
- Built backend services using Flask and integrated PostgreSQL for transactional data consistency.
- Developed modules for online receipts and renewal tracking.
- Designed relational database architecture ensuring ACID compliance and data integrity.
- Implemented encryption and access control for sensitive user data.
- Conducted requirements analysis and translated business needs into technical architecture.
- Collaborated in Agile sprints to deliver incremental, testable system enhancements.
- Optimized database queries to improve performance under concurrent usage scenarios.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Systems Support (Apprenticeship)

Independent Electoral and Boundaries Commission
April 2023 – April 2024

Supported critical IT infrastructure in a high-availability and time-sensitive operational environment.

Key Responsibilities and Achievements:

- Monitored LAN/WAN environments to ensure system availability and reliability.
 - Installed, configured and maintained enterprise hardware and software systems.
 - Performed OS deployments, patch management and proactive system maintenance.
 - Diagnosed application issues; logged incidents in ticketing systems.
 - Assisted in performance optimization and secure configuration management.
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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
Kabarak University — 2019 – 2023

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner** — *In progress (Expected 2026)*
- **DevOps Engineering** — Moringa School (2024)
- **Software Engineering (Full-Stack)** — Moringa School (2024)
- **Jira Certified**

References

Available upon request